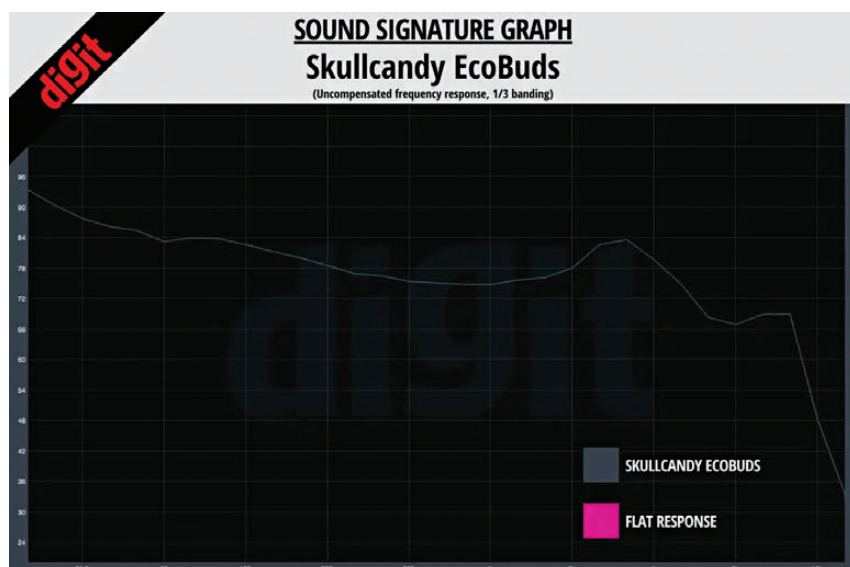




sound a bit laid-back in the overall mix. Frequencies from around 1 kHz to 3 kHz receive a noticeable boost, allowing vocals to cut through without sounding sharp or fatiguing. This works well for genres like pop and rock, where vocals take centre stage. While the mids don't offer studio-grade detail, they are pleasant and smooth, catering well to general listeners.

3. **High Frequencies (Treble):** The treble response, unfortunately, is where the Ecobuds fall short. Starting around 6 kHz, there's a dip that leads to a slightly rolled-off top end. While this prevents harshness and sibilance, it also means the high frequencies lack sparkle and airiness. Complex instrumentals and higher-pitched details are softened, which can be disappointing for those who enjoy intricate highs. Audiophiles may find this treble tuning too relaxed, but it's unlikely to bother the average listener.

To sum it up, the Ecobuds are designed with a warm, accessible sound profile. They're ideal for bass lovers who want a full-bodied sound without excessive sharpness in the upper frequencies. They lack the precision that audiophiles might seek, but for everyday listeners, the sound quality is enjoyable. The microphone quality is passable, per-

forming well in quiet environments, but struggles in noisy settings, especially when compared to earbuds with better noise-cancelling mics.

## BATTERY LIFE

Skullcandy promises up to 5 hours of battery life on a single charge, with an additional 15 hours from the charging case, totalling 20 hours. While this is adequate for casual use, it's not groundbreaking, and heavy users may need to charge more frequently. However, a quick 10-minute charge provides up to 2 hours of playtime, which can be handy for those needing a quick top-up.

Unfortunately, the Ecobuds lack wireless charging, a feature that's increasingly common in mid-range models. For many, this might not be a deal-breaker, but it's something to note if wireless convenience is a priority.

## VERDICT

Skullcandy's Ecobuds offer a blend of sustainability and sound quality that's been a rising trend in the true wireless space. We have brands like Sony, Apple, and the like, joining the race towards making their products more and more sustainable. These earbuds strike a fine balance between environmental responsibility and audio performance. While they might not be "best-in-class" in terms of raw audio quality or feature

set, they offer a commendable alternative for users who care about sustainability without entirely compromising sound and functionality. For most, they'll be a satisfying, eco-friendly choice in the wireless audio market. The sound quality, while bass-heavy, is enjoyable for most music genres and well-suited for casual listening. However, audiophiles or those seeking highly detailed, crisp audio might find these earbuds a bit lacking, especially in the treble range. Battery life, durability, and essential features like Tile integration make them a practical choice for everyday use, even if they're missing some modern conveniences like wireless charging and ANC.

Priced in the mid-range, the Ecobuds offer solid value for those who want reliable, bass-forward audio in a sustainable package. However, users looking for premium features like noise cancellation, aptX support, and brighter sound may find other options more suitable.

—Sativik Pandey

## SPECIFICATIONS

IP Rating: IPX4 | Bluetooth: v5.2 | Wireless range: 10 m | Playtime: Up to 8 hours | Charging Time: 10 minutes for 2 hours of playback | Touch Controls: Yes

## CONTACT

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